PAPER PRESENTATION

Programming Refusal with Conditional Activation Steering

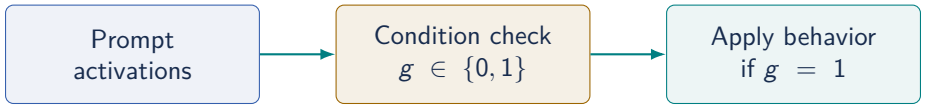
Conditional control of model behavior

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Paper by Bruce W. Lee et al. | ICLR 2025

Control when steering is applied

Activation steering adds a behavior vector to a model's hidden state. CAST adds a condition that decides when to apply it.



$$h' = h + g\,\alpha\,v$$

h: hidden state v: behavior vector α: steering strength

Lee et al., ICLR 2025, Section 3.1; schematic notation.

Three questions about CAST

1. **Why selective refusal?**
   What changes when steering is conditional?

2. **How does CAST work?**
   Condition vectors, behavior vectors, and the gate.

3. **What does the evidence establish?**
   The paper's results, examples, and limitations.